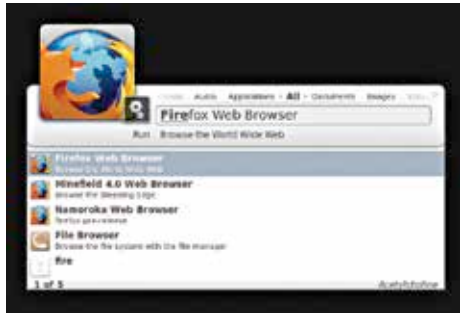


party tool wholeheartedly supports Linux. It even adds some extra features, such as support for multiple accounts, auto-conversion of Google Docs into Microsoft Office compatible formats and notifications for changed files/documents. Insync isn't free though, and comes with a one-time fee of \$15. If you'd rather go the free way, a utility called 'google-drive-ocamlfuse' can be used to mount your Google Drive as a regular disk volume under Linux. You can then interact with your files just as you would with any locally stored ones, and google-drive-ocamlfuse will upload/download the changes.

2. Synapse

Synapse is one of those nifty little apps that you don't know you need until you've used it. It's essentially a desktop launcher – a search box that you can bring up anywhere in your system with a keyboard shortcut, and then proceed to search for almost any kind of data.

Synapse automatically indexes and searches all the files on your hard drive, so that specific documents or media files are found at lightning speed. Since it also recognizes all of the apps installed on your system, it's also the quickest way to launch an app. Simply start typing the name of the app and Synapse will automatically suggest the most likely one. It comes with several plug-ins that can, among other things, perform quick calculations or look up words in the dictionary. If Synapse can't find what you're looking for, it will automatically launch your default web browser and perform a Google search for you.



Synapse is often the quickest way to open apps and files, look up words or perform calculations

3. Crashplan Backup

Every computer needs a backup plan, and Linux systems are no different. The myriad of command line tools available means that the user has plenty of flexibility and control when it comes to formulating a backup plan. These choices, however, may be overwhelming to the new user. Crashplan is a cross-platform, Java-based program that provides a comprehensive, automated backup plan. Available on Windows, Mac, Linux, iOS and Android,